Licensed Child Caring Agency Unannounced Site Visit Report
Residential Care

Licensee: Native American Rehabilitation Association of the Northwest, Inc. (NARA)
Executive Director: Jacqueline Mercer
Program Manager: Luci LaDue
Board Chairperson: Jack Cranford

Date of Unannounced: August 8, 2023
Licensing Coordinator: Robin DuVal

Other Regulatory or Accrediting Agencies: Oregon Health Authority (OHA); Indian Health Service (IHS)

Purpose: Per OAR 419-400-0240 (1)(b) Children's Care Licensing is required to perform at least one unannounced site visit a year where children in care reside.

Previous Findings • **Unannounced Site Visit 11/04/2022**	**Repeat Findings Further Action Needed**	**Comments**
Financial Records 419-470-0170 (4) Records contain date, amount, source, purpose, signatures. Youth signatures are inconsistently captured on the form. The agency shall ensure the form is completed for each transaction and signatures obtained per entry. Youth and staff signatures are consistently captured; however, transactions are not thoroughly documented. The agency shall ensure each transaction is thoroughly completed. **Repeat finding.** • ***This requirement is unmet and further corrective action is needed.***	**Yes☐ No✓**	Financial records were reviewed, and requirements were met. • No further corrective action needed at this time.

New Findings from Site Visit
None

Interview Summary
Two youth, ages 16, who have been in the program approximately 3 months and 2 months respectfully, were individually interviewed. Both reported feeling safe, staff are trusting, food is good and plentiful, peer relationships are going ok, and they get medications as ordered. One reports the staff feel like family and that they've demonstrated what a healthy family could look like. The program does well at having caring staff, being considerate, and taking care of the youth's needs. When asked if the agency could improve or change anything, neither had anything to report. During the visit, I spoke with various levels of management, and reminded them to notify this licensing coordinator of any positive COVID cases. With assistance of various grants, they'll be purchasing new dressers, wardrobes, desks, couches, etc. They report the current census is around 18 and the census has been increasing. This licensor reminded the program of the required ratios of toilets, sinks, and showers to children in care. In addition to the bathrooms and shower rooms within the milieu and bedroom area, there are two working bathrooms down another hallway within the residential portion of the program for use. It was reported that, for the first time since opening this program, the current population of youth has gang related ties and among the current youth, the ties are to opposing gangs. The program purchased and replaced clothing items of certain gang related colors with neutral colored clothing, shoes, and accessories. Parents, guardians, and youth were informed of the rationale, and this licensor recommended that agency review their dress code policy and update as necessary.

Observations
Soon after arriving in the building, it was disclosed that two youth were COVID positive, and the agency instituted face coverings program wide. These youth were in quarantine together in a room separate from the milieu rooms which has a bathroom and shower room within the room, beds, dressers, their belongings, TV with gaming, etc. to make their quarantine time more tolerable. Meals were brought to them. Staff check on them every 15 minutes. Youth and staff have walkie-talkies in the event they need to reach them urgently. The therapist met with each youth prior to sharing this space to ensure they felt safe and comfortable to do so. Youth were observed wearing face masks and relaxing and interacting with staff in the milieu. The environment was welcoming, in good condition and clean. The kitchen and dining room were clean, and plenty of food was observed in the refrigerators, freezers, and pantry. Bedrooms and bathrooms were clean. The classroom was a clean, calming space, and it was reported that the teacher incorporates education and culture in outings. The medication carts in the locked medication room were observed. Upon review of the medication administration records, it appears the youth is initialing one side of the log at the time of receiving their medication, and the staff initials the flip side of the log. This licensor will follow-up and review their policy and procedures to ensure licensing requirements are being met. Across the street from the program building, the agency installed a fenced area of the large lot which is called the "Healing Garden" with areas to sit, graveled pathways, traditional healing plants, and an area slated for a traditional sweat lodge. Youth and staff were observed in this space, and it appeared to be a comforting place to be. As a side note, it was observed that the OHA license posted at the reception area was not the current active license. This licensor requested they post the current license.

Corrective Actions and Timeframes: Please submit the following to verify compliance.

Within 45 days of receipt of this report **Native American Rehabilitation Association of the Northwest, Inc. (NARA)** must submit a letter of verification indicating the agency is in compliance with the specific rules cited above and describing how compliance will be maintained going forward. Along with the letter of verification, the agency must submit any and all specific documentation requested in the body of this report. The letter of verification and any additional requested documents can be emailed directly to **robin.m.duval@odhsoha.oregon.gov.**

Licensing Coordinator's Signature: _____ Date: 8/22/2023

Manager Review: _____ Date: 8-22-2023